Welcome to Word

Instructions you can edit, share, and print

Unlike old-school user guides, this doc is yours to tailor exactly for your needs. Reading it will teach you some basics about Word, but this document isn't just for reading. It's for editing too, so you can learn by doing.

For practice using Word features, watch for **Try it** text in red throughout this document.

Time saver: If you've only got a minute and you want to see how this works, watch this Video: Welcome to Word.

Write eloquently, with a little help

Word automatically checks spelling and grammar, and marks misspelled words with a red squiggly underline. Grammatical glitches get a blue double underline.

Try it: Put your cursor at the end of this paragraph, and hit Enter to start a new paragraph. Write a sentence with some spelling or grammatical mistakes, and press Enter to finish the paragraph.

Right-click the text that's marked with underlines, or Press F7. Choose a suggestion to correct the mistakes.

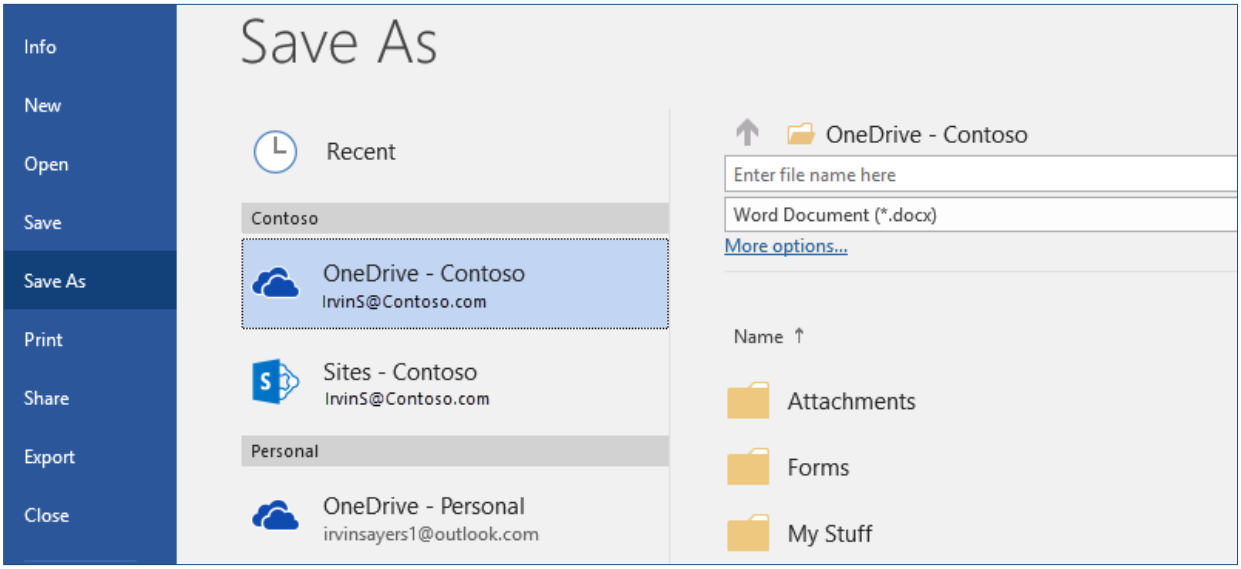
Count on Word to count your words

Try it: Hit return after this line and type some words.

The status bar at the bottom of the window keeps a running count of the number of words in the document.

Save this for later, access it anywhere

When you save this document in OneDrive, you'll be able to open it anywhere: on your computer, tablet, or phone. Your changes will be saved automatically.



Try it: Select **File** > **Save As**, and then select OneDrive and give this document a name.

If you sign in to Office 365 on another device, this document will be in your list of recent files. You can pick up where you left off… even if you left the document open on the computer you're using now.

Share and collaborate

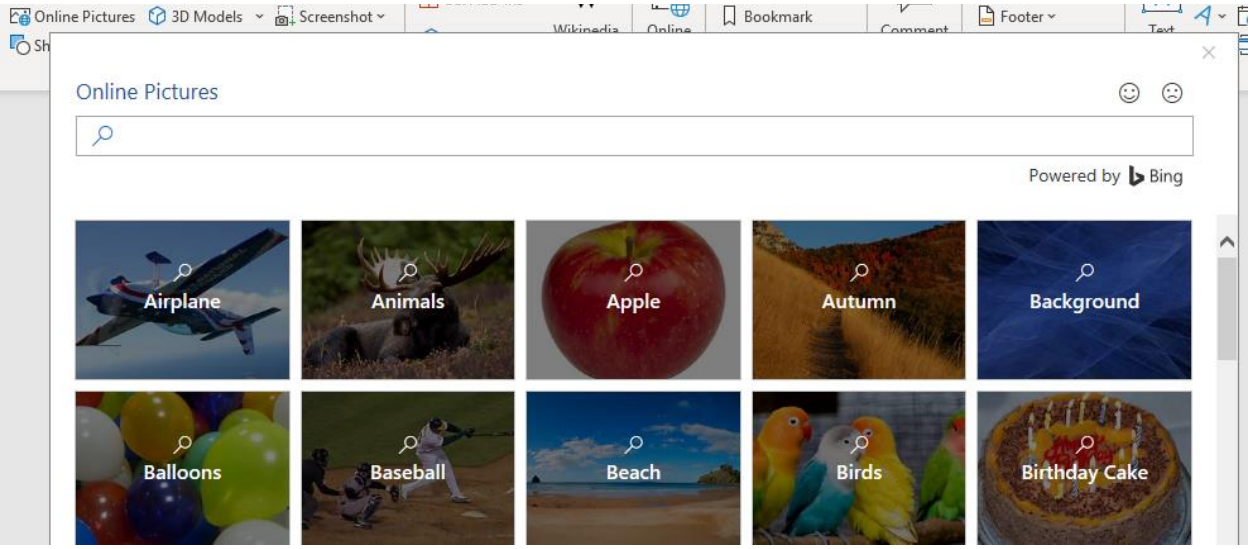
With this document saved in OneDrive, you can share it with others. They don't even need Word to open it.

Try it: Select **Share**, and send a link to this document. (keyboard shortcut – Alt+F+Z or Alt+Z+S)

You can send the link by typing someone's email address or by copying the link and pasting it into a message or chat. If you want them to read the document but not edit it, set their permission to view-only.

If they don't have Word, the document will open in their web browser, in Word Online.

Add visuals with pictures from the web

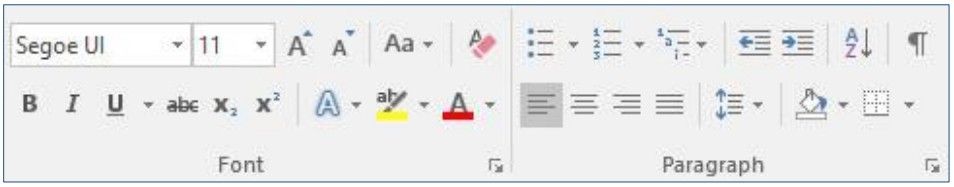


Word works with Bing to give you access to thousands of pictures you can use in your documents.

Try it: Hit enter after this line to make a blank line:

1. With your cursor in the blank space above, go to the Insert tab, select **Online Pictures**, and then search for something, like *puppy clip art*.
2. Select the picture you want, and select **Insert**.

Make your meaning more visual by formatting text



To format text, select it, and then select a button in the **Font** or **Paragraph** area on the Home tab.

Try it: Select text in the lines below and choose formatting options so that the text is an example of the formatting it's describing:

Bold (keyboard shortcut: Ctrl+B)

Italic (keyboard shortcut: Ctrl+I)

Highlight

Font color

Bullets

Numbering

Pro tip: If you selected whole words for this exercise, did you notice that Word popped up a little toolbar, with the font formatting options?

Between that and keyboard shortcuts like Ctrl+B and Ctrl+I, you save time by not having to go up to the Home tab all the time.